

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

WINDOW SEAT
AMRITSAR EAST

IT'S PART OF THE KULCHA

Volleys of allegations and ripostes. A high-acidity campaign that breaks the sound barrier—and the civility barrier. Friends-turned-foes. Fiery speeches. Punjab's Amritsar East is right now a red-hot *tawa*, on which sizzles a Subhash Ghai-style masala blockbuster. In one corner is perhaps the most inflammable substance in Indian politics, Navjot Singh Sidhu—for whom, appropriately enough, they've reprised Churchill's old line, "the bull who carries around his own china shop". Now, Sidhu is the sort to hurl himself like a petrol bomb at anything that stands in the way of his ambitions, including his own party! Who would want to take him on? Who else but the controversial Bikramjit Singh Majithia, Akali Dal No. 2. Armed with a last-minute Supreme Court stay on arrest, and haunted by charges that paint him as the biggest political patron of Punjab's infamous drug trafficking scene, he has left his family fief next door, Majitha, to pick up the gauntlet thrown down by Sidhu. He has

THE MIC



"Be careful of the CAT (Congress, AAP, TMC). If it crosses your path, it will be inauspicious"

SHIVRAJ SINGH CHOUHAN
CM, Madhya Pradesh, while campaigning for the BJP in Goa



"Channi's regime was like a mohalla cricket team. No captain. Sidhu had the bat but kept sulking. Channi wouldn't let anyone else bowl. (Sunil) Jakhar left with all three wickets to Switzerland"

BHAGWANT MANN
President, Punjab unit of Aam Aadmi Party